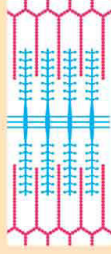


A section of a myofibril is called a **sarcomere**. It is made up of overlapping filaments.

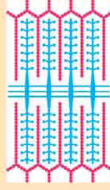
Thin filament
mainly made up
of the protein actin

Thick filament
mainly made up of
the protein myosin

HOW MUSCLES CONTRACT



Relaxed muscle



Contracted muscle

When the brain sends a signal to the muscles, overlapping thin filaments (shown here in red) slide over thick filaments (shown in blue). This makes muscle fibers shorter, causing the muscle to contract.